Daily Foot Care Checklist

Diabetes can reduce sensation and slow healing. Small blisters or cracks can become serious infections. A two-minute daily habit protects mobility.

Every day

- [ ] Wash feet with lukewarm water & mild soap
- [ ] Dry carefully — especially between toes
- [ ] Inspect tops, soles, heels, and between toes
- [ ] Use a mirror or ask for help if needed
- [ ] Apply lotion to tops & bottoms (not between toes)
- [ ] Wear clean, dry socks (seamless if possible)
- [ ] Check shoes for pebbles, nails, rough lining
- [ ] Never walk barefoot indoors or outdoors
- [ ] Trim nails straight across; file sharp edges
- [ ] Note any redness, warmth, swelling, or drainage

Safe habits

- Test water temperature with your elbow/wrist
- Choose well-fitting shoes; break in gradually
- Alternate pairs of shoes when you can
- Keep blood flow moving — wiggle toes, ankle circles
- Don’t smoke — it worsens circulation

Avoid these

- Heating pads / hot water bottles on feet
- Medicated corn removers / razor scrapers
- Tight socks with restrictive tops
- Crossing legs for long periods
- Ignoring “minor” cuts or blisters

Call your clinician promptly for

- New ulcer, blister, or crack
- Puncture wound
- Ingrown toenail
- Red streaks or pus
- Increasing pain or swelling
- Color / temperature change
- Foot fungus that worsens
- Numbness that’s new
- Any wound not improving in 1–2 days

Annual professional check

Ask for a comprehensive foot exam at least once a year (more often with neuropathy, prior ulcers, or poor circulation). Podiatry referral can prevent serious complications.

Educational reference only — not medical advice. Seek urgent care for rapidly worsening infection, fever with a foot wound, or black/blue tissue changes.